not let anyone divide us. Our strength lies in our unity. Let us stand together as one people, as one nation."[51] The government resisted calls for a more forceful response, which were widespread at the time. For example, after the Diwali bombings, the *Times of India* argued that India should "send out a hard-hitting, unambiguous message: that we are not willing to accept such outrages as part of our fate. . . . This is no time to be genteel and 'civilised' in our response. It's time we got angry."[52] According to the *Pioneer*, "By calling for restraint and asking people not to get carried away, the prime minister and his men mock at the memory of those who perished . . . or have been maimed for the rest of their lives."[53]

The Indian government did condemn cross-border involvement in the attacks and promised to defeat the terrorists. But the government's focus was primarily on domestic security measures, rather than on military action or on coercive threats aimed at Pakistan. In the wake of the Mumbai bombings, for instance, Prime Minister Singh highlighted the need to "upgrade our technological capabilities, our electronic surveillance systems, our communication interception capabilities, our access control systems to vital installations and high profile targets, . . . [to] improve ground level intelligence, [and] to have rapid response plans to ensure effective management" after a terror attack "and quick restoration of normalcy."[54] The Indians took no rhetorical or military steps to threaten to attack Pakistan as they did during the 2001–2002 crisis.

If a provocation on the scale of the Parliament attack were to occur in the future, however, the outcome might be very different. India might well launch a major militarized response against Pakistan, regardless of Pakistani nuclear weapons.[55] Indeed, the political pressure to do so could be overwhelming. As one prominent Indian strategic analyst puts it, "In the event of another major terrorist attack there will be an uproar and it will be politically impossible for the government not to respond."[56] In addition, Indian leaders continue to believe, as they did during the Kargil conflict and the 2001–2002 crisis, that they can engage Pakistan in large-scale conventional combat without starting a nuclear war.[57] Thus the Indian government's domestic and military calculations could create strong incentives for severe retaliation.[58]